I also believe that everybody and everything influence our work and I love watching people work and demonstrate. There's always something to be learned!
JS: The main person who has influenced my turning is dad because he is always there and I mainly see the things that he brings home. However, I also love going to Yandles and watching people demonstrate turning; it has blown my mind many times. I love watching Les Thorne, he is also so funny! And always gets dad to get me an extra ice cream!

Nick Agar has also influenced me because I have watched him demonstrate and he is also a good friend of dad's and has given me various turning tips.

If you were to offer one sage piece of advice to someone what would it be?

SS: I would encourage someone to follow the path that inspires them while keeping an open mind and understand that sometimes there is no right or wrong, just different! Also, find a good tutor if you need to learn new techniques.
JS: Follow your heart and enjoy having no boundaries in the things you can create! And if you don't have a Dad to help you along the way, ASK because from my experience people are always willing to help!

What music and which book are you currently into

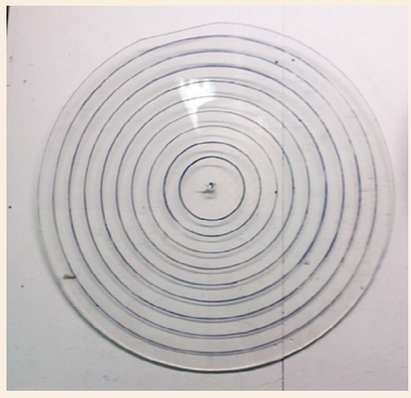
SS: When I am in the workshop I normally have Heart radio on but truthfully I rarely hear any of it because I am so focused on the project in hand. If I am in Nick's workshop, it could be anything! I don't read a lot of books as I always seem to have my iPad in my hand doing research or sending emails. I do have a lot of woodturning books but just seem to pick them up to scan for ideas.
JS: When I am woodturning, dad and I have Heart FM on, however, I am the same as most teenagers and love modern music especially Ed Sheeran and Taylor Swift. My favourite book at the moment is *Divergent*; it is also my favourite film as well. I also love looking through dad's woodturning books for inspiration.

What is your silliest mistake?

SS: Most mistakes are silly! And I think we all make them but the silliest one seems to be sometimes putting the lathe in reverse to sand and forgetting when starting a new piece and wondering why it's not cutting!
JS: I don't make that many silly mistakes because dad is always there to make sure that I don't, however somehow I still manage to make some. My silliest one is that I was trying to spray dad with the watering spray bottle but I missed and it got a little bit on my bowl which I had just finished. The water gave it white spots and I had to start all over again.

HOMEMADE JIG

This simple centre finding jig was made out of a piece of scratched Perspex. I had seen them in photos but could not find one to buy. It was so easy to make and is even easier to use. Jess and I use it all the time, it is without doubt the most-used jig in our workshop. Saying that, I have just taken delivery of a new router jig for the lathe and I am sure looking forward to having fun with that!



Copper reactive paint and ageing fluid with pyrography

What has been your greatest challenge?

SS: Trying to apply my business brain to woodturning and the sale of my work. I am lucky that I don't need the money to livebut understand that other people do, so I try to never under sell my work and value it on time spent and costs. The rest of the bits stay in my collection! Just finding the time to progress my work is another great challenge!
JS: My greatest challenge was learning not to be scared of turning; bits of wood flying around at high speed took a little bit of getting use to! Also to apply a decent amount of pressure without hesitation to give that smooth cut.

Name one thing on your turning to-do list.

SS: To make that piece that everyone think 'How did he do that?'
JS: To continue to gain confidence and be able to make things that are mind-blowing, challenging and completely beautiful.

Tell us about the piece you are currently working on.

SS: I think like most turners I always have many projects on the go at one time. I am also working on different techniques. At the moment I am using metal patination and reactive paints. Every piece of work turns out differently using these products, which I find so interesting!

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